GET INVOLVED

How to Participate

Phase 0 is the right moment to ask questions, raise concerns, and help shape what comes next. There is no single path to getting involved.

Village Residents & Landowners

Your land, local knowledge, and voice are essential. Join the community consultation process and help shape the design of what is built here.

Foresters & New Residents

Paid, multi-skill roles as we double the co-op crew — with relocation & training grants. Plus feasibility & technical partners.

Investors & Philanthropists

Phase 0 funding for feasibility studies, legal structure, and early community outreach. Impact-first approach.

Researchers & Academics

Collaborate on open data, carbon measurement, rural energy modelling, and ecological monitoring.

Other Rural Communities

Everything built here is documented and shared openly — free for any village facing the same challenges to replicate and adapt.

JINJA FESTIVAL

VILLAGE EVENTS

Biomass Energy & AI

REFORESTING IN MITSUE

mitsue.it

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Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture, Japan

Version 2.5 · August 2026

PHASE 0 · 2026

森林再生

FOREST REGENERATION SHINRIN SAISEI

BIOMASS ENERGY & AI

Reforesting in Mitsue

75 Years to Grow the Forest, 25 Years to Harvest

Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan

MITSUE VILLAGE · NARA · JAPAN

THE PROJECT

Three Pillars

Forest Restoration

Aging cedar monoculture converted to native mixed forest by a scaled-up village forestry cooperative (御杖村森林組合) — its crew roughly doubled. Landowners begin receiving timber income from Year 2.

Biomass CHP & Energy Resilience

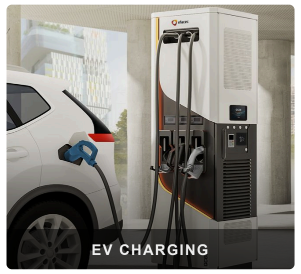
Sugi forest thinnings fuel a biomass CHP system providing electricity (primary) and heat (secondary) — the forest powers the village. Solar panels and EV charging for residents and visitors complement the system, with blackout resilience built in.

Sustainable AI Data Center

A small, efficient digital facility inside a repurposed vacant school or factory building, powered entirely by local renewable energy — creating local employment and stable long-term revenue where none existed before. Phase 2 expands to a larger site in Mitsue.

> *"These are not three separate ideas — each one makes the others possible."*


CEDAR FOREST


EV CHARGING


COMMUNITY

PHASE 0 · NOW OPEN

What We're Building

A small vacant school or factory building and its surrounding cedar forest — transformed into a living model of rural self-sufficiency for Japan and the world.

WHY THIS PLACE?

- ✓ Small vacant factories available for reuse
- ✓ Productive cedar forest within reach
- ✓ Resident engineer with deep local roots since 2012
- ✓ Village leadership open to new ideas
- ✓ Advances Mitsue Village's official Renewable Energy Plan (2025)
- ✓ Proven open-data ethos from Safecast

FUNDED BY

林野庁 forest grants · METI/NEDO biomass & rural energy grants · 御杖村 地域脱炭素移行・再エネ推進交付金 (via village) · FIT/FIP feed-in tariff revenues · J-Credit carbon offset income · Data center service revenue · Impact investment & philanthropy

ADVISORS

Ray Ozzie — Executive Chair, Blues

Takuo Dome — Professor Emeritus, Osaka University · Director, Inochi Forum

San Poisson — Project Manager

Evin Zoet — Co-Representative Director, Transom

Yoshiko Zoet-Suzuki — Co-Representative Director, Transom

Henry Seiichi Takata — Representative Director, SynTech Japan Co., Ltd. · U.S.-Japan Council; biomass-CHP advisor


Mitsue-kun

MILESTONES

Timeline

Benefits arrive well before Year 25 — the 25-year horizon describes full forest restoration, not how long the village waits for results.

Year 1	Site reactivated as datacenter hub; international media visibility for Mitsue Village
Year 2	Landowners begin receiving income from cedar harvest
Year 3–4	Biomass CHP unit & EV charging stations operational; battery storage for blackout resilience
Year 4–5	Data center operational; local jobs in operations & maintenance created
Year 5–10	Data service revenue reinvested into village and forest programmes
Year 25	Native mixed forest established; model fully documented and shared openly worldwide

About the Team

Rob Oudendijk — Dutch electrical engineer born in the Netherlands (the same country that is home to ASML), resident of Mitsue since 2012. Core hardware developer for *Safecast*, the open citizen science network born after Fukushima, with over 250 million radiation measurements published openly since 2011.

A dedicated non-profit is being established with local residents, village leadership, forestry professionals, and academic partners.